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# Soobin Um

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## Education

- Aug. 2021 – **Ph.D. in Artificial Intelligence**, KAIST, Daejeon  
Aug. 2025 Advisor: Prof. Jong Chul Ye
- Feb. 2012 – **M.S. in Electrical Engineering**, KAIST, Daejeon  
Feb. 2014 Advisor: Prof. Wan Choi
- Mar. 2008 – **B.S. in Media Communication Engineering**, Hanyang University, Seoul  
Feb. 2012 *Summa Cum Laude* (GPA: 4.13/4.5)

## Work Experience

- Aug. 2026 – **Assistant Professor**, DGIST, Daegu  
Present Department of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science
- Sep. 2025 – **Assistant Professor**, Kookmin University (KMU), Seoul  
Aug. 2026 Department of Artificial Intelligence
- Feb. 2014 – **Senior Researcher**, Agency for Defense Development (ADD)  
Aug. 2021 Wireless communication and network systems for military applications

## Research Interests

Generative AI, Trustworthy AI, AI for Science, Physical AI

## Publications

\* Co-first, † Co-corresponding

- Journal **[J1]** Physics-Guided and Fabrication-Aware Inverse Design of Photonic Devices Using Diffusion Models  
Dongjin Seo\*, **Soobin Um**\*, Sangbin Lee, Jong Chul Ye, Haejun Chung  
*ACS Photonics (2026)*
- Conference **[C9]** Self-Improving Diffusion Classifiers with Minority Preference Optimization  
Hyunsoo Kim, Jungmyung Wi, **Soobin Um**, Donghyun Kim, Suhyun Kim  
*ECCV 2026*
- [C8]** Beyond Generative Priors: Minority Sampling with JEPA-Guided Diffusion  
Sol Park, **Soobin Um**  
*ICML 2026*

[C7] Diverse Text-to-Image Generation via Contrastive Noise Optimization  
Byungjun Kim\*, Soobin Um\*, Jong Chul Ye  
*ICLR 2026*

[C6] DPAIL: Training Diffusion Policy for Adversarial Imitation Learning without Policy Optimization  
Yunseon Choi, Minchan Jeong, Soobin Um, Kee-Eung Kim  
*NeurIPS 2025*

[C5] Boost-and-Skip: A Simple Guidance-Free Diffusion for Minority Generation  
Soobin Um\*, Beomsu Kim\*, Jong Chul Ye  
*ICML 2025*

[C4] Minority-Focused Text-to-Image Generation via Prompt Optimization  
Soobin Um, Jong Chul Ye  
*CVPR 2025 (Oral presentation, top 0.74%)*

[C3] Self-Guided Generation of Minority Samples Using Diffusion Models  
Soobin Um, Jong Chul Ye  
*ECCV 2024*

[C2] Don't Play Favorites: Minority Guidance for Diffusion Models  
Soobin Um, Suhyeon Lee, Jong Chul Ye  
*ICLR 2024*

[C1] A Fair Generative Model Using LeCam Divergence  
Soobin Um, Changho Suh  
*AAAI 2023 (Oral presentation)*

Workshop [W1] Physics-guided Optimization of Photonic Structures using Denoising Diffusion Probabilistic Models  
Dongjin Seo\*, Soobin Um\*, Sangbin Lee, Jong Chul Ye, Haejun Chung  
*NeurIPS 2024 Workshop (ML4PS)*

Preprint [P1] MotionCFG: Boosting Motion Dynamics via Semantic Motion Sharpening  
Byungjun Kim, Soobin Um<sup>†</sup>, Jong Chul Ye<sup>†</sup>  
*NeurIPS 2026 (under review)*

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## Research Grants & Projects

Aug. 2026 – **DGIST Faculty Start-up Grant:** Diffusion Models in AI for Science

Dec. 2029 Funded by DGIST — **KRW 300M**

(ongoing) Role: **Principal Investigator**

Apr. 2026 – **Regional Innovation Leading Company Development R&D Program:** AI-

Mar. 2028 Based Battery State Diagnosis for Electric Two-Wheelers

(ongoing) Funded by the MSS (TIPA) — **KRW 534M (Subcontract PI share: KRW 100M)**

Role: **Subcontract PI**

Apr. 2026 – **AI S&T Innovation Technology Development Program:** Development of AI for

Dec. 2029 Multi-Scale Drug Response Transfer Prediction Based on Biological World Models

(ongoing) Funded by the MSIT (NRF) – **KRW 3B (Co-PI share: KRW 800M)**

Role: **Co-Principal Investigator**

- Oct. 2025 – **Future Defense Innovative Technology Program:** AI-Driven Long-Range  
 Mar. 2028 EO/IR/SWIR Sensor Fusion System  
 (ongoing) Funded by the MSIT (NRF) — **KRW 400M**  
 Role: **Principal Investigator**
- Sep. 2025 – **AI Star Fellowship Program (Kookmin University):** Embodied AI with Multi-  
 Aug. 2026 modal Foundation World Model for Robotics  
 Funded by the MSIT (IITP)  
 Role: Participating Researcher
- Sep. 2024 – **Basic Science Research Program Grant** on Robust Generative AI  
 Aug. 2025 Funded by the MoE and MSIT (NRF) — **KRW 25M**  
 Role: **Principal Investigator**
- Jun. 2023 – **Development of AI-Based X-Ray Computer-Based Training Program**  
 Jun. 2024 Field-oriented Technology Development Project for Customs Administration  
 Funded by the MSIT and Korea Customs Service  
 Role: Student Researcher
- Jan. 2023 – **Development of AI Technology for Personalized Plug-and-Play Explanation**  
 Jun. 2023 **and Verification of Explanation**  
 Funded by the MSIT (IITP)  
 Role: Student Researcher
- Sep. 2021 – **Development of a Framework to Analyze, Detect, and Mitigate/Remove**  
 Aug. 2022 **Bias in AI Models and Training Data**  
 Funded by the MSIT (IITP)  
 Role: Student Researcher

## Patents

- Registered **[PR18]** Apparatus, Method, Computer-Readable Storage Medium and Computer Program for Assigning Dynamic Frequencies in Wireless Network  
 Patent No. 10-2212367, Jan. 2021.
- [PR17]** Method and Apparatus for Satisfaction Degree based Weighted Fair Resource Allocation Optimization in Cognitive Radio Wireless Network  
 Patent No. 10-2204935, Jan. 2021.
- [PR16]** Apparatus and Method for Controlling Performance of Receiver for Sub-Device in MIMO Cognitive Radio Systems  
 Patent No. 10-2192564, Dec. 2020.
- [PR15]** Full Duplex Pair Matching Method for Improving Network Performance in Full Duplex Network Environment  
 Patent No. 10-2178266, Nov. 2020.
- [PR14]** Successive-Cancellation Fano Decoding Apparatus and Method for Decoding Using the Same  
 Patent No. 10-2158312, Sep. 2020.
- [PR13]** Apparatus and Method for Controlling Channel of Cognitive Radio  
 Patent No. 10-2107015, Apr. 2020.

**[PR12]** Data Convergence Method for Reducing Overhead of Cognitive Radio Networks

Patent No. 10-2085205, Feb. 2020.

**[PR11]** Method and Apparatus for Selecting Frequency Band in Cognitive Radio Network

Patent No. 10-2042260, Nov. 2019.

**[PR10]** Method and Apparatus for Allocating Frequency Resource in Cognitive Radio Ad-Hoc Network

Patent No. 10-2039650, Oct. 2019.

**[PR9]** Apparatus and Method for Scheduling Slots for Communication of Data Packets

Patent No. 10-2038051, Oct. 2019.

**[PR8]** Apparatus and Method for Constructing Rate-compatible Polar Code

Patent No. 10-1996026, Jun. 2019.

**[PR7]** Time Mirroring Method and System for Airborne Relay Communications

Patent No. 10-1901616, Sep. 2018.

**[PR6]** Space-Time Dynamic Spectrum Access Apparatus Combined by Multi-Beam Array Antenna and Time Division Duplexing and Frequency Division Duplexing

Patent No. 10-1873102, Jun. 2018.

**[PR5]** Radio Set System and Setting Channel Method for the Radio Set System

Patent No. 10-1832971, Feb. 2018.

**[PR4]** Phased Array Antenna System

Patent No. 10-1773481, Aug. 2017.

**[PR3]** Radio Apparatus for Sensing Space Frequency Spectrum

Patent No. 10-1764655, Jul. 2017.

**[PR2]** Polarization tracking system using dual polarization antenna with variable gain attenuator and the control method of the same

Patent No. 10-1747789, Jun. 2017.

**[PR1]** A Dynamic Spectrum Access Technique based on OFDM for P2P Communication

Patent No. 10-1632267, Jun. 2016.

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## Honors & Awards

May 2026 Silver Reviewer Award, ICML 2026

Aug. 2020 Bronze Medal, National Defense Science Award, ADD

Aug. 2020 Achievement Award, ADD

Jun. 2018 Outstanding Paper Award, KICS Winter Conference

Feb. 2012 *Summa Cum Laude*, Excellence Award, Hanyang University

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## Invited Talks

- Sep. 2026 *Guided Diffusion in AI for Science: from Inverse Design to Rare-Instance Synthesis*, the NRF/DFG Joint Workshop on Machine Learning for Urban Environmental Modeling and Flows
- Jul. 2026 *Inclusive Generative Models for Robust Physical AI*, IEIE Summer School
- Aug. 2025 *MinorityPrompt*, Korean AI Association - KAIA Summer Conference
- Aug. 2025 *MinorityPrompt*, Poster Session at KCCV 2025
- Jul. 2025 *MinorityPrompt and BnS: Recent Advances in Diffusion-Based Minority Sample Generation*, Visual AI Lab, Princeton University
- Jul. 2025 *Physics-Guided and Fabrication-Aware Inverse Design Using Diffusion Models*, The McMahon Lab, Cornell University (Co-presented with Dongjin Seo)
- Aug. 2022 *Diffusion Probabilistic Models: A Gentle Introduction*, SpiderCore

## Teaching Experience

- Instructor**
  - Computer Networks (Fall 2026, DGIST)
  - AI Ethics (Spring 2026, KMU) — *4.94/5.00 Teaching Eval.*
  - Data Structures (Spring 2026, KMU) — **Top 1.97%** *Teaching Eval.*
  - Generative AI (Fall 2025, KMU) — *Top 20% Teaching Eval.*
  - Data Science (Fall 2025, KMU) — *Top 20% Teaching Eval.*
- TA**
  - AI501: Machine Learning for AI (Spring 2023, KAIST)
  - AI619: AI for Medical Imaging (Fall 2022, KAIST, **Head TA**)
  - EE424: Introduction to Optimization (Fall 2021, KAIST)
  - EE210: Probability and Introductory Random Processes (Fall 2013, KAIST)
  - EE321: Communication Engineering (Spring 2013, KAIST)
  - Data Science: Modeling for Prediction (Feb. 2022, Hyundai Motors)
  - Data Science Master Program (Sep. 2021 – Nov. 2021, Hyundai Motors)

## Professional Service

- Area Chair** ICLR 2027
- Reviewer (Conferences)** CVPR (2024–2026), ICLR (2025–2026), ICML 2026, ECCV 2026, NeurIPS 2026, WACV 2026
- Reviewer (Journals)** IEEE Transactions on Image Processing (TIP), Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR)